

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 664

By Oliver

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Nashville Electric Service line workers and State and Metro Nashville civil service employees for their brave and tireless efforts during Winter Storm Fern.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of the members of this General Assembly to recognize those devoted Tennesseans who, in the discharge of their duties, commit long hours and often put themselves in harm's way in order to ensure the well-being of their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Winter Storm Fern first hit Nashville on January 24, 2026, bringing with it snow, sleet, and freezing rain that coated trees, roads, and power lines in a layer of ice, accompanied by frigid temperatures that lingered for several days; and

WHEREAS, this historic ice storm resulted in the closure of schools and offices throughout the Nashville area, and approximately 230,000 Nashville Electric Service (NES) customers were left without power, even as temperatures plummeted into the single digits; and

WHEREAS, in response to this, the largest single outage in its history, NES doubled its workforce following day one of the storm; by January 26, 2026, NES had 631 line workers on the job, bringing more the following morning for a total of 925 responding to the crisis; additional crews were called in from Florida, Maryland, Kentucky, Indiana, Ohio, Mississippi, and elsewhere in Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, these brave individuals endured perilous circumstances, braving the extreme cold at all hours to restore power to their fellow Tennesseans; and

WHEREAS, NES line workers are members of the Service Employees International Union (SEIU) Local 205, a union chartered in Tennessee of diverse members in health care, the public sector, and property services, as well as members of the International Brotherhood of

Electrical Workers (IBEW), AFL-CIO, and Laborers' International Union of North America (LIUNA); and

WHEREAS, others who played a critical role in keeping residents of Nashville and surrounding counties safe during this time are civil service employees of Metro Nashville government, including Office of Emergency Management and Metro Nashville Public Schools, and state agencies, including the Tennessee Emergency Management Agency and the Tennessee Bureau of Investigation; and

WHEREAS, these exemplary professionals are truly dedicated to their jobs and to the well-being of their fellow Tennesseans, and for their prodigious efforts on behalf of the people of this State, they should be recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commend and offer our appreciation and most sincere thanks to the Nashville Electric Service line workers and State and Metro Nashville civil service employees who worked tirelessly to keep Nashville residents safe during Winter Storm Fern. We extend our deepest appreciation to these heroic Tennesseans, who, in a moment of great peril, came to the aid and rescue of their fellow citizens.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.